



PRODUCT DESIGN · TECHNICAL ANTHROPOLOGY · BROOKLYN

leuan King akaBuild

A product designer and technical anthropologist working on the human side of applied AI — discovery, approval flows, and the interfaces that make agents legible and worth trusting. I build tools and create art.

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WHO I AM

The human side of applied AI.

I design and build the surfaces where people and AI systems meet: discovery and research flows, approval and review interfaces, evidence and citation UX, and the copy conventions that make agentic tools feel legible. I prototype in code, validate with real users, and ship production front-end alongside the design work.

Alongside design: agent skill-building and testing, custom evaluation work, front-end engineering, and procedural 3D. I also produce and perform electronic music — some of the tools in this portfolio exist because I needed them on stage.

FOCUS

PRODUCT DESIGN

HITL & AGENTIC UX

USER RESEARCH

FRONT-END

AGENT EVALUATION

PROCEDURAL 3D

3.5 yrs

UBIK STUDIO

2

STUDIOS RUN TODAY

20+

SHIPPED PROJECTS

IN THIS PORTFOLIO

- 01 Ubik Studio — a desktop AI research platform, 2023–2026
 - 02 Circleheads (co-founded) & akaOSS (independent) — the studios
 - 03 Box Populi — client work for a NYC live-techno collective
 - 04 akaCOVART — a generative album-art studio, live
 - 05 akaVSTs & Hologram — instruments & agent observability
- Practice & contact

CURRENT WORK



STUDIO · APPLIED AI · BROOKLYN

Circleheads · circleheads.com

The two-person applied-AI software studio I co-run — applied AI in production, a small consulting bench, and original games on the side.

Applied AI — agentic systems that do real work.

Consulting — a short bench, senior only.

Games — strange things, quietly built.



STUDIO · OPEN SOURCE · HITL AI

akaOSS · akaoss.dev

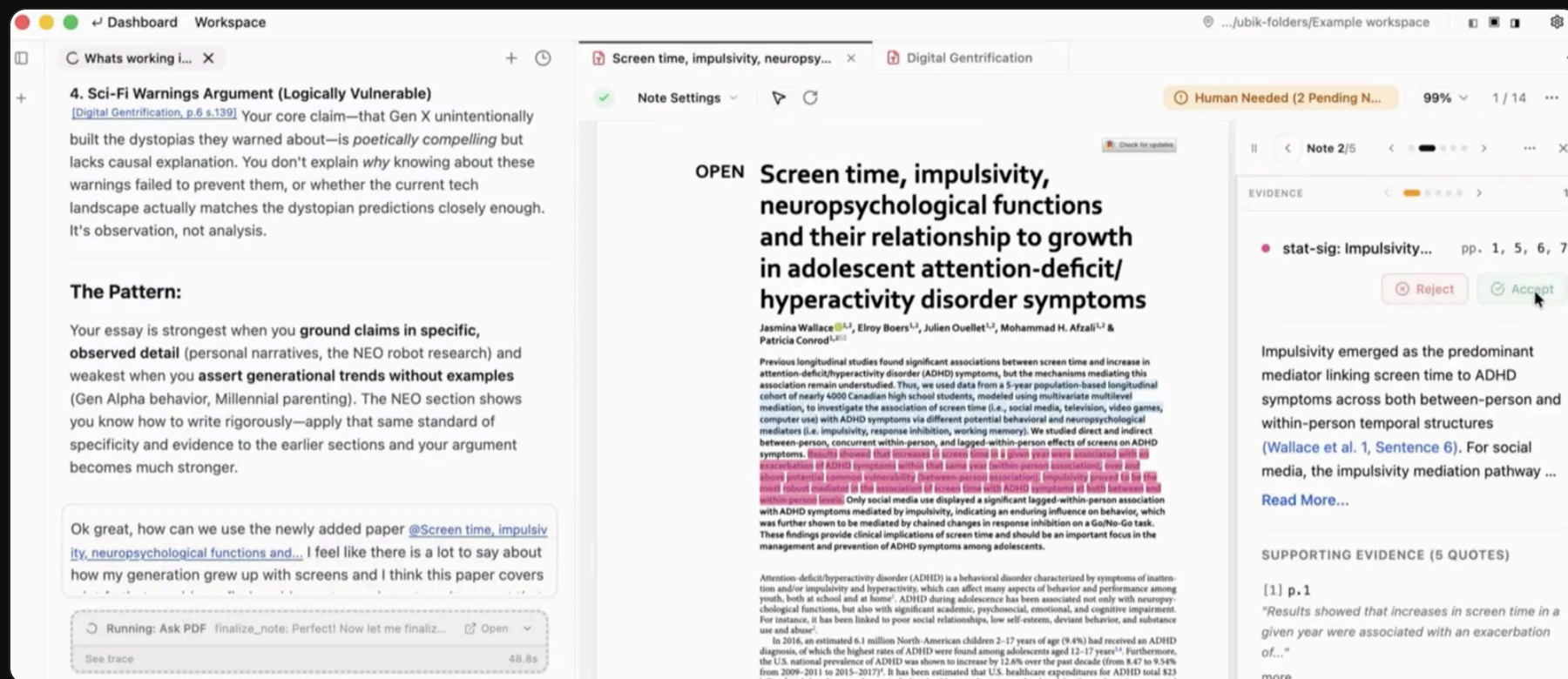
My independent open-source studio — software for human-in-the-loop AI: a measurement family for AI that assists without displacing, and tooling for the agents that build alongside you.

HITL Kit — HITL AI, measured properly · shadcn CLI + npm

eval-kit — measurement for multi-step agents

tag-kit · **Collapse** · **Hologram** — annotation & agent tooling

Ubik Studio



The three-pane workspace — agent chat on the left, the source paper in the middle, and an evidence panel on the right where each extracted claim is accepted or rejected by hand.

Three and a half years co-founding a desktop-native AI research platform. Any folder became a research workspace: agents searched the literature, read sources in parallel, and drafted documents where every claim traced back to a real quote on a real page — and everything of consequence passed through a human first.

I led product design end to end — the workspace model, review surfaces, evidence and citation UX — built front-end throughout, ran the user research cycles, and designed and built the custom evaluation framework and ARC eval suite we used to train and tune our agents and orchestration systems, with direct, measurable effects on output accuracy, quality, and real-world usability.

Can you explain... X

Files

Workspace Bibliography

Digital Gentrification

Integrating Evidence into Digital G...

es into your Digital Gentrification document? I can
ate a revised version that weaves in this evidence
pought.

sources cited

n you create a document that briefly explains what
sites and claims from those sources could help
prove [Digital Gentrification](#)

Completed: Run Create Workflow Process... Open
24.2%

We created a guide, ["Integrating Evidence into
Digital Gentrification"](#) [Integrating Evidence into Digital Ge
ntification](#), which outlines exactly how to weave these
research findings into your original piece.

reaks down the integration into four key areas:

- Neurobiological Evidence:** How to use the
"digital dementia" findings to provide a biological
foundation for your claim that digital platforms are
"extractive."
- Behavioral Pathways:** How to use the
"impulsivity" findings to explain the mechanism of
how screen time actually rewires the brain's
ability to inhibit impulses.
- Generational Validation:** How to use the
"generational differences" research to support
your "critical witness" thesis.
- Practical Application:** Where to place this
new evidence to strengthen your existing arguments
about parental mediation.

u can now open the document to see the specific
findings and suggested placements for your revision.
ould you like me to help you apply these changes to a
draft of your original piece next?

1 item to review

Human Needed

Agent Gemini 3.1 Flash

Previous Document ready for content generation.

Digital gentrification represents more than a metaphor for displacement; it describes the
systematic transformation of digital environments at the expense of original users, often
mirroring the physical pressures of urban renewal ([Erisson 2](#)). To deepen this critique, one
must look beyond social architecture to the biological and psychological impacts of the digital
tools themselves. By integrating recent evidence on digital dementia, impulsivity, and
generational cognitive divergence, we can move from a sociological analysis to a holistic
framework that explains how platform design actively reshapes human capacity. This guide
outlines how to weave this empirical evidence into the core arguments of the Digital Gentrification
thesis, providing a more robust account of the human cost of platform-driven
development.

HUMAN needed

Clarifying the scope of integration

More...

This section should briefly articulate why biological evidence is necessary for the digital gentrification
argument. Does it shift the focus from "exclusion" to "impairment," or is it meant to supplement the
existing critique of labor?

The integration of this evidence is not merely supplementary; it reframes digital gentrification as a process of cognitive
displacement, where the very tools of the digital environment sap the capacity of original users to participate
effectively.

The integration of this evidence is not merely supplementary; it grounds the critique of extractive design by showing
how platform-induced cognitive changes function as a form of "digital eviction."

Write what should appear here...

791 Words

Strengthening the Argument with
Neurobiological Evidence

The claim that digital spaces are "gentrified" implies an active exclusion of specific user
demographics ([Erisson 2](#)). By incorporating neurobiological findings, this argument gains
empirical weight, shifting from a sociological critique of platform design to a physiological
analysis of user degradation. The concept of
cognitive capacity due to excessive screen
time is well-documented, showing how
this exclusion ([Ali et al., 1](#)).

791 Words

Bibliography

Human Needed

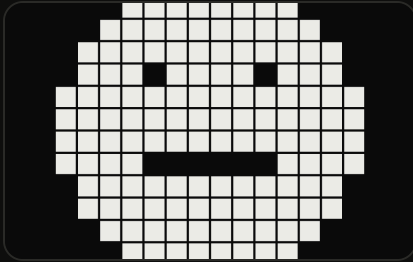
UBIK STUDIO

Circleheads

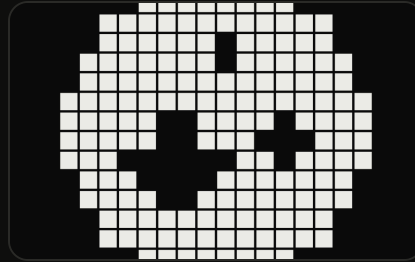
Co-founder · Applied-AI software studio · circleheads.com

We watch the work first, then ship agents that do it in production — with the data they need, the skills they use, and approval gates that keep humans in control. Plus a short senior consulting bench and original games built in-house.

- **My hand:** product design and technical anthropology, plus skill-building, agent testing, front-end, and procedural 3D.
- **Brand system:** I designed and built the studio's generative pixel identity — a canvas animation engine shared across our sites.



The circlehead — brand engine still



The akaOSS spark — same pixel language

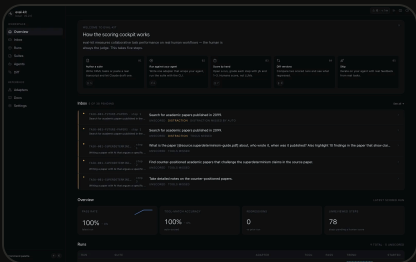
APPLIED AI CONSULTING GAMES

akaOSS

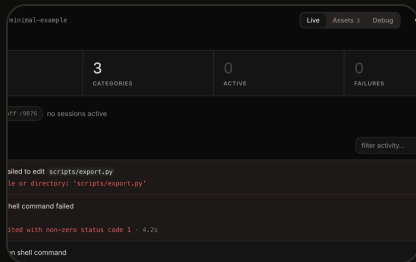
Founder · Open-source studio for HITL AI · akaoss.dev

Five open-source projects served as one site, built on one thesis — Assist-Not-Complete: evaluate AI on whether it assists humans without displacing them, not on whether it can finish the task alone.

- **HITL Kit** — 15 React primitives for human-in-the-loop UI, installable via the shadow CLI, with a perspective paper.
- **eval-kit** — a measurement instrument for multi-step research agents: humans score, not LLMs.
- **Collapse & Hologram** — developer tools for Claude Code skills and live Blender→gITF pipeline observability.



eval-kit — run overview



Hologram — live pipeline dashboard

OPEN SOURCE HITL AI RESEARCH

Box Populi

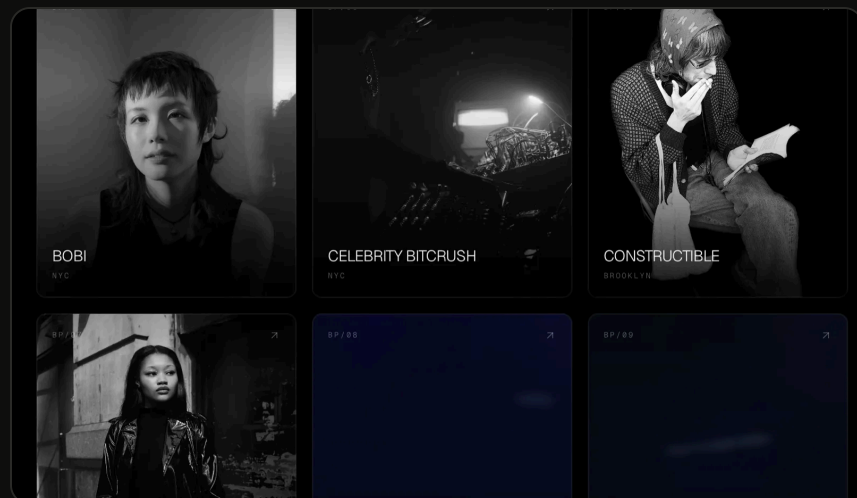


The landing — a club-flavored home for a NYC live-techno improvisation collective, with a persistent header player that keeps the latest set playing across every page.

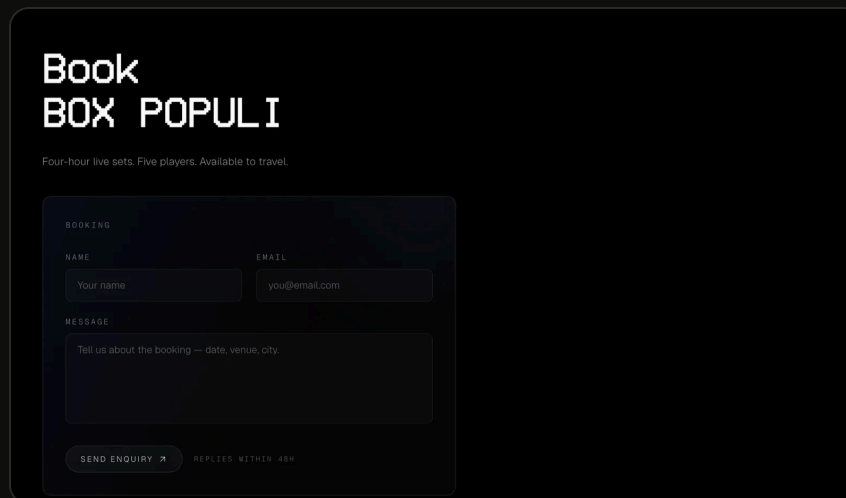
A client project for Box Populi, a rotating cast of NYC artists playing continuous, multi-hour improvised techno. The brief: a fast, dark, on-brand public face for the crew's roster, live sets, and bookings — built so the client can run it themselves. (I also play in the collective, which made the client feedback loop unusually direct.)

The whole site is roster-driven: a typed data model generates the landing page, the crew grid, and a profile page for every artist, so the collective can grow without anyone touching layout code. Custom on-brand players run over the official SoundCloud Widget API — dark glass cards with our own transport, SoundCloud as the sanctioned host.

Honest engineering: a module-level audio bus pauses every other player when one starts, and the header set survives navigation. iOS only starts audio in a synchronous tap — so touch devices get a one-time "Double Tap" hint instead of a hack. No user-agent sniffing; every capability check is CSS.

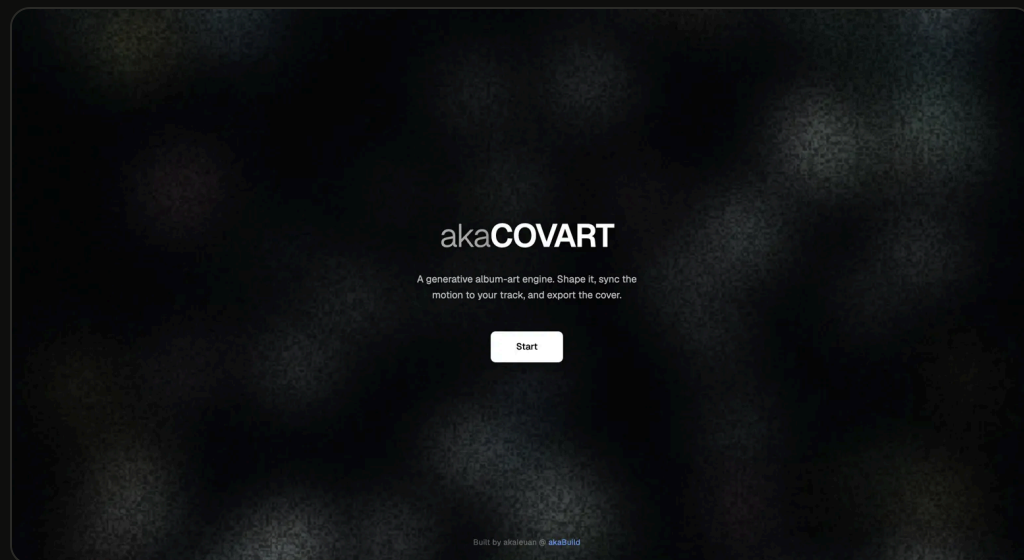


The roster grid — every card generated from a one-line data entry, so the crew grows without layout work.

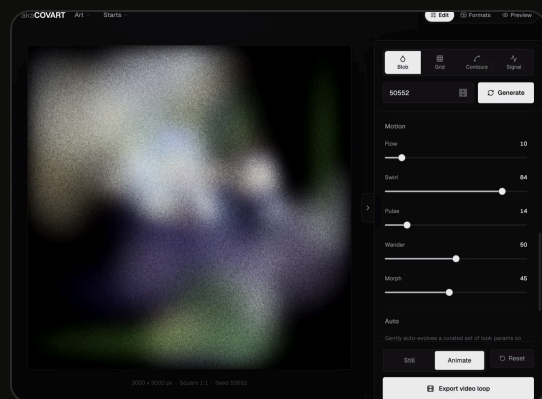


The booking pipeline — "four-hour live sets, five players, available to travel," backed by a transactional-email enquiry form.

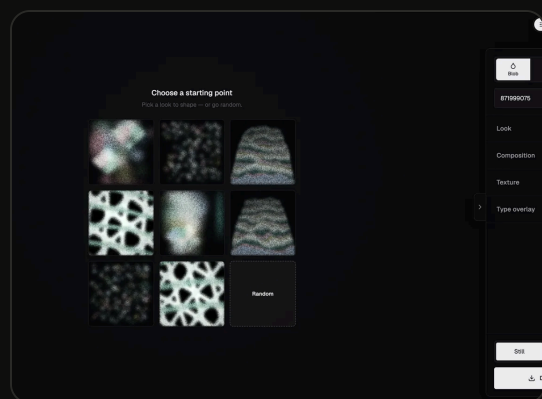
akaCOVART



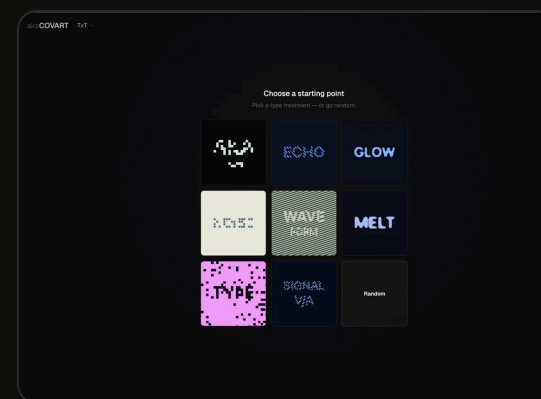
The studio's front door — a generative album-art engine, live at akacovart.com.



The Edit view — a Blob cover with its Motion rack (Flow, Swirl, Pulse, Wander, Morph) and a one-click video-loop export.



Art focus starting points — curated looks across the Blob, Grid, Contours, and Signal engines.



TxT focus — the title becomes the subject: Dither, Lines, and Blur type engines with per-glyph composition controls.

SELECTED WORK · 05

akaVSTs

Three instrument plugins · JUCE / C++ · VST3 & AU



akaBLEEP — acid synth with a 64-step P-lock sequencer.

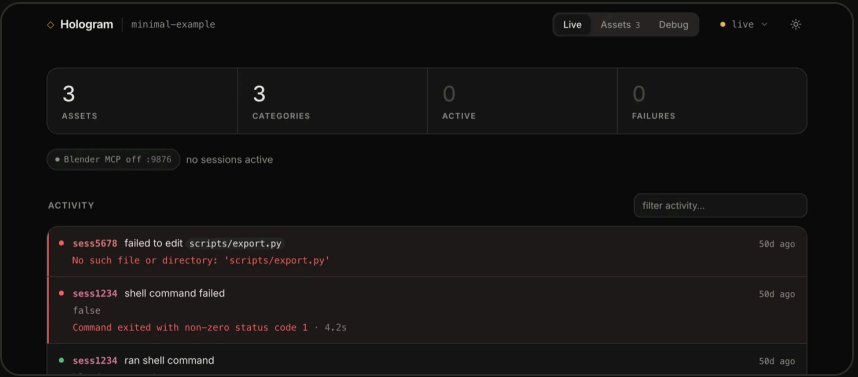


akaENZYME — four-layer lo-fi synth with shared voice pool.

Instruments I play live and use in my own music — built for live recording with dedicated FX and performance-focused controls, not preset-browsing.

Hologram

Agent observability for 3D pipelines · v0.6.0 on PyPI · MIT



The live dashboard — the agent's pipeline activity next to the assets it produces.

My AI coding agent writes the Blender scripts and runs the glTF exports for the games I build — and I had no idea what it was doing. Hologram closes that gap: it tails one event log and streams the agent's live activity — edits, shell commands, exports — next to the assets those actions produce, in one local dashboard.

Then it hands the same pipeline back to the agent as MCP tools — enumerate, introspect, health-check, and a non-destructive render through live Blender, so the agent can see an export, not just count its nodes. Deliberately read-only; it never modifies an asset. Stdlib Python, no build step, no database.

PRACTICE

How I work.

Watch the work first.

Mixed-methods research — structured interviews, behavioral observation, and session replays — synthesized into prioritized UX decisions rather than slide-deck summaries. Every cycle is anchored in trust, evidence attribution, and meaningful human control, and the findings feed interaction specs, flow changes, system prompts, and microcopy in the same shipping rhythm as the product. The validation logs stay public.

Prototype in code, at scale.

I turn intent into high-quality working surfaces — web and desktop — fast enough to stay aligned with the people using the product. The same weeks usually include interviews, screen replays, and light data analysis, so the next build is shaped by what we're seeing in the field, not by a static milestone.

Measure what matters.

Most AI is judged on autonomous completion while real deployment is collaborative. I evaluate agents on whether they assist people without displacing them — in the product, in the copy, and in how the systems behind it are trained and tested. The long-form version of that argument is my paper, An AI Measurement Problem, at kraa.io/akaieuan.

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Full write-ups, interactive demos, and live projects at akabuild.dev/demo.